

Hope Beyond Shores

MVP Website Project Overview

A modern editorial website for island stories, faith, community, and life beyond the shore.

PLAIN-TEXT PROJECT PLAN

1. Project Overview

Hope Beyond Shores will be a responsive storytelling website for a writer who documents island life, local communities, faith, hope, and meaningful experiences around Bantayan Island and nearby communities. The public website will serve as a digital journal, while a secure owner dashboard will allow the writer to manage the landing page and publish stories without editing code.

The MVP will focus on the smallest complete release that is useful to both the writer and her readers. It will prioritize strong writing, authentic photography, easy content management, mobile usability, and dependable security.

Project goals

- Present Hope Beyond Shores as a credible and memorable storytelling platform.
- Give readers a clean and enjoyable way to discover island stories.
- Allow the owner to create, edit, preview, publish, and unpublish stories.
- Allow the owner to update important landing-page content.
- Provide an optional contact form without requiring visitor accounts.
- Create a secure foundation that can support future features.

2. Brand and Design Direction

The visual style will resemble a carefully designed travel journal or independent editorial publication. It should feel warm, personal, natural, and human-made rather than looking like a generic AI-generated template.

Theme colors

- Warm Cream (#F5EFE6) - primary page background.
- Soft White (#FFF8F8) - reading surfaces and clean content areas.
- Deep Brown (#4A2F24) - headings, navigation, and primary actions.
- Earth Brown (#795548) - secondary elements and supporting text.
- Caramel (#B98252) - links, active states, and restrained highlights.
- Sand (#DEC9AD) - subtle dividers, borders, and quiet backgrounds.
- Dark Espresso (#2D211C) - main body text.

Typography and interface

- Lora for story titles and editorial headings.
- Inter for navigation, controls, metadata, and body text.
- Lucide Icons for practical interface actions such as menu, search, location, edit, save, and logout.
- No robot, sparkle, magic-wand, glowing-brain, or other AI-associated icons.
- No excessive gradients, floating blobs, glass effects, or unnecessary card layouts.
- Authentic photography, thoughtful spacing, readable line lengths, and subtle motion will create visual character.

3. Public Website

Landing page

- Responsive navigation and mobile menu.
- Editorial hero with an owner-managed title, introduction, call to action, and image.
- Short introduction to the mission of Hope Beyond Shores.
- A featured story selected by the owner.
- Latest published island stories.
- Featured islands or locations.
- Writer profile and personal introduction.
- Selected photo highlights.
- Facebook link and invitation to follow the page.
- Optional visitor message form.
- Footer with contact and social details.

Story archive

- Browse all published stories.
- Search stories by title or keyword.
- Filter stories by category or island location.
- Display cover images, short summaries, locations, and publication dates.
- Use clear empty, loading, and error states.

Individual story page

- Cover image, story title, introduction, author, date, category, and location.
- Readable long-form story content with headings, paragraphs, quotations, captions, and photographs.
- Related stories and a simple Facebook sharing link.
- Stable story URL based on a unique slug.

Visitor access

Readers will not need to register or create profiles. Published content will be publicly readable. Visitors may submit a message, but their name, email address, and contact information may remain optional.

4. Owner Dashboard

The dashboard will be available only to the owner through a protected login. Its design will use the same cream, brown, and white identity, with a more compact layout for efficient content management.

Story management

- Create, edit, preview, publish, unpublish, and delete stories.
- Add a title, summary, category, location, cover image, and story content.
- Upload additional photographs and write captions.

- Save unfinished work as a draft.
- Select or remove a featured story.
- Automatically record created and updated dates.

Landing-page management

- Update hero text, call-to-action text, and hero image.
- Update the About section and writer profile.
- Choose featured stories, locations, and photo highlights.
- Update contact information and Facebook link.

Message management

- View visitor messages.
- Mark messages as read or unread.
- Delete messages that are no longer needed.

5. Technology Stack

Frontend

- HTML5 for semantic page structure.
- CSS for the responsive layout, theme, typography, and interface components.
- Vanilla JavaScript for interactions, API requests, validation, filtering, and dashboard behavior.
- Lucide Icons for a consistent and lightweight icon system.

Backend and data

- Node.js as the server runtime.
- Express.js for the REST API and application middleware.
- Supabase PostgreSQL for stories, categories, settings, and messages.
- Supabase Storage for story images and landing-page media.
- Supabase Authentication for the owner account.

External-file requirement

The project will not use inline CSS or inline JavaScript. Shared behavior and feature-specific behavior will be organized into separate external files. The frontend will have dedicated style and script files for the landing page, story archive, story details, contact form, authentication, dashboard, editor, and media management. The server will separate routes, controllers, middleware, validation, services, configuration, and utilities.

Suggested data groups

- profiles - owner identity and role.
- stories - title, slug, summary, content, status, location, category, and dates.
- story_images - images, captions, and display order.
- categories - reusable story categories.
- locations - islands and community locations.

- site_settings - editable landing-page and contact content.
- messages - optional visitor information, message content, and read status.

6. Security Layers

Security will be applied at the browser, Express server, Supabase database, and storage levels.

Core protections

- Supabase Authentication for the owner.
- Server-side authorization for every dashboard and content-management request.
- Supabase Row Level Security policies with least-privilege access.
- Service-role credentials stored only on the server and never exposed to the browser.
- Helmet security headers and a strict Content Security Policy.
- A strict CORS allowlist for the production website.
- Global API rate limiting plus stronger limits for login, contact, and upload routes.
- Server-side schema validation and sanitization for all incoming data.
- Parameterized database operations and controlled query fields.
- File type, file size, filename, and upload-path validation.
- Request body size limits.
- Secure session handling and generic authentication errors.
- Honeypot and spam controls for the public contact form.
- Environment variables for secrets and environment-specific configuration.
- Safe production errors that do not expose stack traces or database details.

7. MVP Scope and Priorities

Included in the first release

- Polished, responsive landing page.
- Story archive and individual story pages.
- Secure owner login.
- Story draft and publishing workflow.
- Story and cover-image uploads.
- Basic landing-page content management.
- Optional visitor contact form and simple message inbox.
- Essential search and category or location filtering.
- Security, validation, responsive behavior, and accessibility basics.

Recommended for later versions

- Visitor accounts and reader profiles.
- Public comments or reactions.

- Email newsletter subscriptions and campaigns.
- Donations or payment processing.
- Advanced analytics dashboard.
- Full multilingual content management.
- Multiple writers and complex permission levels.
- Automatic social-media synchronization.

8. Key Recommendations

- Make the stories the main visual and content focus; the dashboard exists to support the writing.
- Use real island photographs wherever possible. Strong authentic images will do more for the brand than decorative graphics.
- Begin with one owner role and a simple writing workflow to keep the MVP dependable.
- Provide a focused editor with only the formatting tools the writer actually needs.
- Use draft, preview, and publish states to reduce accidental publishing.
- Compress uploaded images and use responsive image sizes for good mobile performance.
- Treat mobile as a primary experience because many readers will arrive through Facebook.
- Write meaningful page titles, descriptions, headings, and story URLs for search visibility.
- Create clear empty and error states so the interface always explains what the owner should do next.

9. Definition of a Successful MVP

The MVP is successful when a visitor can comfortably discover and read Hope Beyond Shores stories on a phone, tablet, or desktop; the owner can securely sign in and publish a complete story with images without editing code; landing-page content can be updated from the dashboard; visitor messages are safely collected; and the website remains clear, fast, accessible, and consistent with its cream, brown, and white editorial identity.

End of project overview